

JAMES MITCHELL

Software Engineer (Staff Level)

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Staff Software Engineer with 14 years of experience building scalable backend systems and leading technical initiatives across fintech and e-commerce sectors. I've spent the last six years mentoring junior engineers while architecting microservices that handle millions of transactions daily. My focus has always been on writing maintainable code and solving complex distributed systems problems without overcomplicating solutions.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer

FinanceFlow Solutions

www.financeflow.io

London, United Kingdom

March 2021 - Present

Led the design and implementation of a real-time transaction processing system handling 50,000+ requests per second using event-driven architecture and Apache Kafka, resulting in 40% reduction in processing latency.

Mentored a team of five junior and mid-level engineers, conducting code reviews and establishing coding standards that improved deployment frequency from fortnightly to daily releases.

Architected the migration of a monolithic payment processing application to microservices using Docker and Kubernetes, reducing infrastructure costs by 35% while improving system reliability.

Established monitoring and observability practices using Prometheus and ELK stack, which caught production issues before customer impact on three critical occasions.

Principal Engineer

TechVenture Ltd

www.techventure.co.uk

Coventry, United Kingdom

July 2017 - February 2021

Designed and built a distributed caching layer using Redis that improved application response times by 60% and reduced database load significantly across our platform serving 2 million users.

Led a cross-functional team of engineers and product managers through a major API redesign that maintained backward compatibility while enabling new features, resulting in zero migration issues for 150+ client integrations.

Implemented comprehensive automated testing strategies and CI/CD pipelines using Jenkins and GitLab, reducing bug escape rate to production by 75% and improving developer confidence in releases.

Owned the technical roadmap for backend infrastructure, making strategic decisions about technology choices that positioned the company for the next phase of growth.

Senior Software Engineer

DataWorks Digital

www.dataworks.net

Birmingham, United Kingdom

January 2010 - June 2017

Developed and maintained core data processing pipelines written in Java that handled batch jobs processing 10TB of data daily for business intelligence and reporting systems.

Optimized SQL queries and database schemas that improved reporting query performance by 70%, enabling real-time dashboards previously only available as overnight batch jobs.

Introduced version control best practices and Git workflows to a team of eight developers, eliminating merge conflicts and improving collaboration on a legacy codebase.

Contributed to the open-source Java community by reporting bugs and participating in architectural discussions that influenced platform development decisions.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, Python, Go, SQL, JavaScript

Backend Frameworks and Tools: Spring Boot, Hibernate, Express.js, FastAPI

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis

Messaging and Streaming: Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ, AWS SQS

Cloud and Infrastructure: AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, Lambda), Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform

Monitoring and Logging: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Datadog

Development Practices: CI/CD, Git, Agile methodologies, Test-Driven Development

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Manchester

Graduated: July 2009

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Published two technical articles on microservices architecture in industry publications

Active contributor to internal technical documentation and architecture decision records

Completed AWS Solutions Architect Associate certification in 2019